School Closure Report

Sabin Elementary School

Date: 11/17/2026

School Closure Process
The PPS Board of Education determines whether schools will be closed. Board determination on school closures is based on the Superintendent's recommendation. The School Initiation & Closure policy (6.10.030-P) requires that the Superintendent's recommendation be accompanied by a School Closure Report.

If you have questions about this process or this report, please contact:

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501 N Dixon, Portland, OR 97227 | 503-916-2000

1. School Profile

School Name
Sabin Elementary School

Administrator
Madeleine Allen

Location
4013 NE 18th Ave, Portland OR

Grade levels served
K-5

1a. School Description

Sabin Elementary School is a Northeast Portland neighborhood K–5 school and is currently part of the Grant cluster. It hosts a Social Emotional Skills classroom and on-site, after school childcare. Approximately 250 students are enrolled at Sabin for the 2026-27 school year.

1b. Financial Impact

The primary financial benefit of consolidating elementary schools and programs is to align school capacity and operating costs with enrollment, allowing PPS to concentrate limited resources in fewer, more efficiently resourced schools. Combining school communities can reduce duplicative school-level administrative and operating expenses, improve building utilization, and support more efficient staffing and program delivery. These consolidations are intended to generate ongoing savings while supporting strong core instructional programs and student services.

If the school remains open, the projected cost per student for the 2027/2028 school year is: $19,741.

If the school is closed in 2027, the projected overall savings is $898,472. This includes savings from administrative, custodial, and office staffing, 80% of utilities, and includes the one-time cost of teacher moves. We anticipate ongoing expenses, including 20% of current utility costs and an average annual security cost, if the school were closed and unoccupied.

Under the proposed change, 32% of students would live more than one mile from Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. and would be offered school bus transportation. To accommodate these students, PPS anticipates Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. will continue to have two buses. The Transportation Department anticipates no cost because the number of buses remains the same.

Transportation and Safe Routes to School planning will identify needed supports for safe arrival and dismissal, including walking and biking improvements, crossing supports, or traffic circulation changes.

1c. Student Enrollment

Table 1. Projected enrollment over the next five years, if school remains open:

School Year	2027-28	2028-29	2029-30	2030-31	2031-32
Students Enrolled	236	248	240	234	235

History of Requested and Actual Transfers

During 2024-25, 2025-26, and 2026-27 school years, 54 students requested transfers into Sabin, and 19 enrolled through an approved transfer. During the same period, 152 students residing within the school's attendance area requested transfers to other schools, and 47 enrolled elsewhere through an approved transfer.

Projected declining enrollment will make it difficult to maintain stable staffing, full programming, and essential student support services. Under enrollment-based staffing allocations, low enrollment can result in year-to-year staffing changes, blended-grade classrooms or combined programs, and reduced access to enrichment and student support offerings. Staff may serve multiple roles or split time across schools, limiting continuity and availability. While educators would continue working to meet students' needs, projected enrollment would constrain the school's ability to provide consistent access to a well-rounded educational experience without ongoing supplemental district resources.

2. School Facilities and Student Reassignment

2a. School Description

Built	Building size	Stories	Acres
1928	65,769 SF	3	3.63
Building condition	**Gross capacity**	**Functional capacity**	**Cost of school operations**
Fair; FCI 0.08	780	621	$4,895,684

Gross capacity is the estimated maximum number of students a school can accommodate, calculated by assigning a student capacity to each classroom based on its square footage and summing those capacities:

- Less than 800 square feet: 24 students
- 800–1,000 square feet: 27 students
- More than 1,000 square feet: 30 students

Functional capacity is a practical estimate of the number of students a school can accommodate, calculated by multiplying its gross capacity by the applicable utilization rate. It does not represent maximum occupancy under building code requirements or determine staffing levels.

The cost of school operations includes projected FY28 school-based costs in funds 100 and 200 plus Facilities, Nutrition Services, and Special Education, at the current service level.

Physical Condition of Building, Capital and Environmental Needs

Sabin is a three-level, brick-faced reinforced-concrete school with portable facilities and a covered play structure. Assessments conducted in 2019–2020 identified much HVAC equipment beyond its typical design life, corroded and leaking boiler circulation pumps, aging electrical distribution and interior lighting, and some flooring and casework beyond design life; there are also plumbing and heating replacement needs. The assessment reported recently replaced fire-alarm equipment in good condition and a wet-pipe sprinkler system protecting corridors, stairwells, and classroom entrances without major observed deficiencies.

ADA Accessibility

The first floor is accessible through an entrance on the side of the building and there is an elevator that provides access to the basement and second-floor classrooms.

Building Use

Currently, Sabin houses a K–5 neighborhood school with general education classrooms, a Social Emotional Skills classroom, enrichment instruction, and student support services.

Analysis of current and potential use of the facility, including recommended disposition

Following closure, potential uses of the Sabin Elementary School facility will be evaluated through the district's Building Repurposing process, informed by community engagement, district needs, facility conditions, and financial considerations. This process will consider opportunities to support students and the surrounding community and identify a recommended future use or disposition for Board consideration.

2b. Student Reassignment

The proposed closure of Sabin Elementary School would move its full neighborhood K–5 boundary to Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. Elementary. Benefits include MLK Jr.'s updated roof, larger grounds, and outdoor facilities. Students in Sabin's Social Emotional Skills program would also receive services in K–5 SES classrooms at Dr. Martin Luther King Jr., with individual placements determined by the Special Education Department in collaboration with school teams and families.

Proposed Attendance Boundary

See attached map.

Transportation options and barriers

Transportation options include walking, biking, family transportation, and school bus service for elementary students who live more than one mile from their neighborhood school; additional students may qualify based on Oregon Department of Education guidelines or individual needs. We do not anticipate any barriers to students getting to school; however, additional busing may be provided, as needed, for hazard areas within the school attendance boundary.

How will this school location accommodate the reassigned students?
Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. Elementary has 34 classrooms and a functional capacity of 584 students. After consolidation with Sabin, Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. is projected to hold 572 students in the 2027-2028 school year.

Recommendation
PPS recommends closing Sabin Elementary School for the 2027–2028 school year and assigning its full neighborhood K–5 boundary to Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. Elementary. SES placements at Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. would be coordinated with school teams and families.

3. Community/Cluster and District Impact Analysis

3a. Cluster Analysis

How will the proposed closure maintain or improve equity of access to schools offering high quality educational choices?

In the school year 2026-27, Portland Public Schools staffs and supports 56 elementary programs across the district. Eleven of these programs are situated within K-8 campuses. Enrollment ranges from 160 students to over 550 students. Using the QEM and our system definition of “well-resourced schools” as a guide, we have established an elementary enrollment of 360 as the minimum threshold to be able to staff and support a comprehensive and stable elementary program. Maximizing the number of sites at or above this minimum threshold allows the district to maximize the number of students who experience grade-level classrooms, comprehensive core enrichments, and targeted academic supports. It also maximizes the number of educators who work full-time on one campus and who benefit from regular collaboration with grade- and content-alike colleagues.

By operating fewer elementary schools and spreading current enrollment more evenly across remaining sites, the district can offer a more comprehensive and sustainable program at each elementary site.

In recent years, we have used resources from other parts of our system to subsidize elementary programs with low enrollment. Given our current and projected budget shortfalls, we can no longer sustain subsidies for underenrolled sites. As a result, elementary schools have already faced several programmatic and operational constraints:

- Over half of our elementary programs have been forced to place students in multi-grade classrooms;
- Instructional coaches, academic coaches, and school climate support positions have been cut;

- Core enrichment teachers that support Arts, PE, and Library/Media instruction have been split across multiple sites, reducing the capacity to have full-school enrichment programs;
- Support staff that help monitor lunch and recess have been reduced, forcing principals to spend much of their time monitoring duty;
- Opportunities for strong teacher collaboration and professional learning have been compromised by multi-grade classrooms and single-strand programs.

If we continue with no rightsizing action, all of these constraints will be compounded in the 2027-2028 school year.

3b. Effects on Other Schools, Enrollment, and Community Access

The proposed merger would affect Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. Elementary within the Jefferson cluster. Enrollment at Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. Elementary is projected to change from 319 to 572 in the 2027–2028 school year. Based on these projections, there will be two to three classrooms at each grade-level. These changes would support a combined elementary school community, with opportunities to stabilize staffing and sustain educational programs and student supports. Implementation will require coordinated staffing, classroom assignments, and use of shared spaces to accommodate incoming students while supporting students already enrolled. Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. is ready to receive students and would need a very minimal kitchen upgrade (a warming cabinet). There already are sufficient instructional and student support spaces, and we would continue to coordinate any additional supports needed to accommodate the combined school community.

Sabin Elementary School is located approximately one mile from Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. Elementary School. Nearby community resources include Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. School Park. The proposed change would shift students' daily school activities toward Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. Elementary and its adjacent park, while potentially increasing travel to existing childcare arrangements and resources near Sabin. Transportation options include walking, biking, family transportation, and school bus service for eligible students. PPS would support school bus service for students who live more than one mile from the school and work with the school community and the district Safe Routes to School coordinator to identify appropriate crossing, pedestrian, and bicycle safety measures.

3c. Community Partnerships and Potential Community Impact

Sabin currently partners with Chess for Success and the Black Parent Initiative to provide family and student programming. Sabin's closure risks interrupting these services. While both organizations previously operated at Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. School, those partnerships ended prior to the 2026–27 school year. PPS will coordinate with both organizations and school leadership to explore resuming services at Dr. Martin Luther King Jr., where Sabin students are projected to transition, or to identify alternative community partnerships.

Sabin currently partners with Neighborhood House, an established child care provider serving four PPS communities. The Sabin program serves 58 students, with an additional 10 on its waitlist, while Neighborhood House at Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. school currently serves 44

students. Relocating the Sabin program to Martin Luther King Jr. would allow families to keep their same provider, but would require appropriately licensed space to accommodate up to 102 enrolled students. Child care spaces must meet state licensing requirements, which involve additional time and costs, making early planning essential. District leadership, Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. administration, and Neighborhood House will collaborate early to establish a clear transition plan, ensure reliable access to appropriate space, and protect the needs of both school communities. Preserving this partnership would maintain continuity for families, support an established community provider, and create opportunities to address the existing demand for accessible child care.

Sabin currently partners with Self Enhancement, Inc. (SEI) to operate its SUN Community School, providing wraparound services and family support through a collaboration between PPS, Multnomah County and the City of Portland. SEI's partner organizations include Chess for Success, Tiny Dance Life, Soo Bahk Do, Sabin PTA, Motion Magic, NW Children's Theater, Ethos, and Adventures in Spanish provides free extended-day enrichment opportunities, access to a food pantry, and culturally relevant programming supported by staff who reflect and understand the student population. SUN also serves as an important connection point for students and families to access individualized support, community resources, enrichment opportunities, and basic-needs assistance. Closure could affect student and family access to established relationships with SUN staff, enrichment providers, and community resources, as well as require adjustments to programming locations, partner operations, and access to existing supports. Opportunities for partnerships to continue include transitioning students and services to Dr. Martin Luther King Jr., which also operates a SEI-led SUN Community School. Having the same community-based organization operating SUN at both schools creates an opportunity to maintain service continuity, preserve established relationships, and coordinate student and family transitions within an existing service system.

Services requiring further coordination include assessing Dr. Martin Luther King Jr.'s capacity to accommodate additional students and service needs, coordinating SUN staffing and program resources, maintaining access to enrichment partners and basic-needs supports, and ensuring students can continue receiving individualized and wraparound services without interruption. Additional community impacts include the potential disruption of trusted relationships, enrichment opportunities, and established points of connection for families accessing community resources, with proposed responses including coordinating with SEI and Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. school leadership to develop a transition plan, identify staffing and resource needs, communicate with families, and prioritize continuity of services and student participation in existing programs.

Any future community use of the facility would be considered through the Building Repurposing process.

3d. Operational Plan & Boundary Map

If approved, the closure would take effect in 2027, with students assigned to Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. Elementary under the proposed boundaries shown in the attached boundary map.

Following Board approval, PPS will coordinate staffing, student assignments, receiving-school improvements, technology preparation, transportation, and the relocation of school materials and equipment. The following timeline summarizes key operational milestones. School-specific

schedules will coordinate building improvements, cleaning, moving, technology installation, and staff access so receiving schools are prepared before students arrive.

Operational Implementation Plan

Timeline*	Action
January 2027	Establish school transition teams and school-specific implementation plans. Verify student enrollment. Share Principal assignments with communities.
February 2027	Develop staffing plans and confirm initial staff assignments. Identify and prioritize building improvements, equipment, and technology needs.
March 2027	Identify initial classroom assignments and develop school-specific moving schedules, distribute packing supplies, and begin records transfers.
April 2027	Begin packing and sorting materials not needed for daily instruction. Finalize plans for building improvements and technology setup.
May 2027	Confirm summer moving and building-work schedules. Continue packing and prepare materials for transportation and other operational services for receiving schools.
June 2027	Complete teacher packing. Begin school moves after the school year ends and carry out scheduled building improvements.
July 2027	Continue school moves and building improvements. Install furniture, equipment, and technology at receiving schools.
August 2027	Complete scheduled moves by mid August. Finish cleaning, classroom setup, and technology testing.
September 2027	Monitor school operations and address remaining transition needs. Complete closing-building inventories.

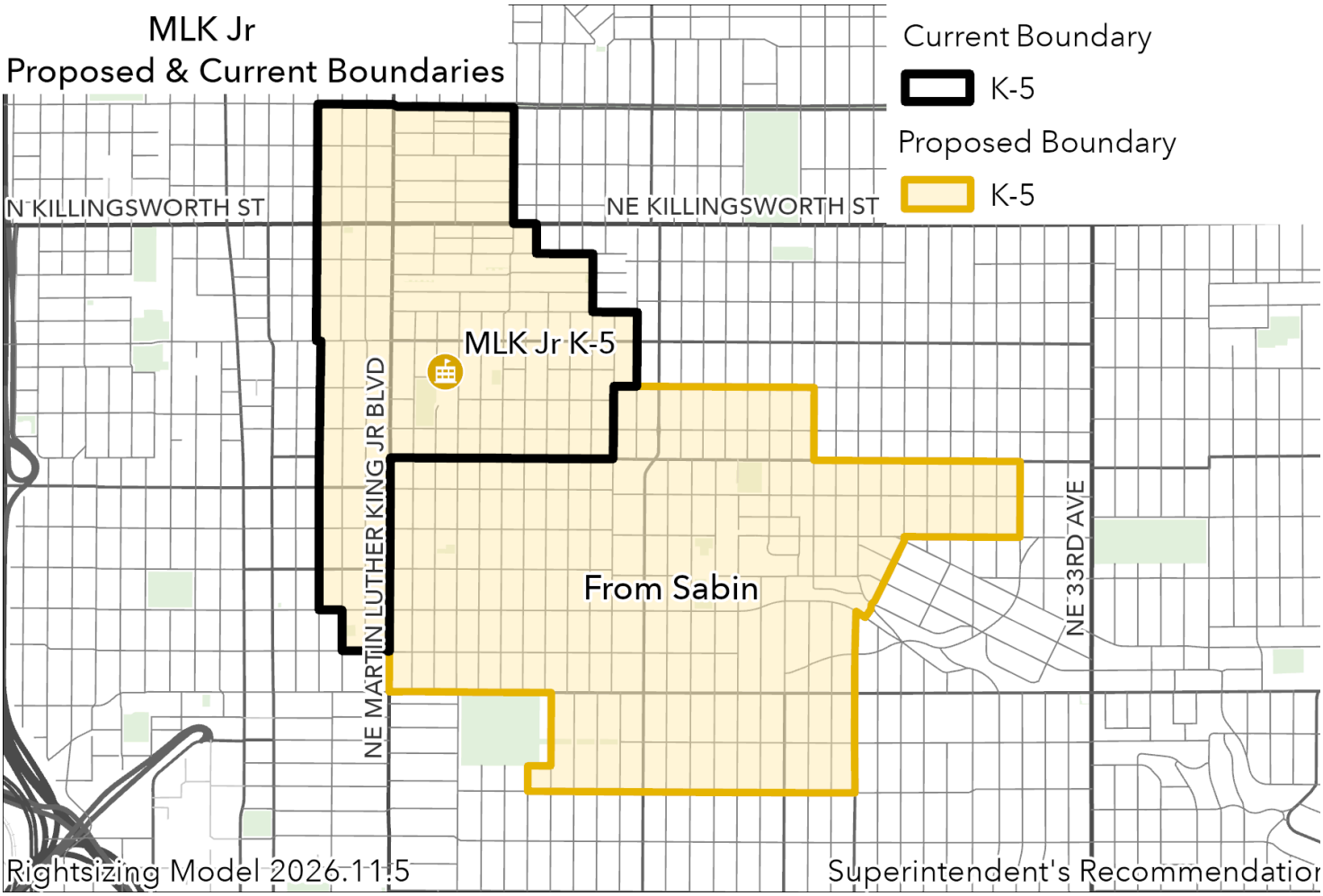
**Subject to change*

Review and Approval

This report has been reviewed by appropriate district staff.

Superintendent Signature

Date


MLK Jr
Proposed & Current Boundaries
Current Boundary
K-5
Proposed Boundary
K-5
N KILLINGSWORTH ST
NE KILLINGSWORTH ST
MLK Jr K-5
NE MARTIN LUTHER KING JR BLVD
From Sabin
NE 33RD AVE
Rightsizing Model 2026.1 1 5
Superintendent's Recommendation